

Team Members:

Isaac Padilla, Karina Rivera, Juan Reyna, Ricardo Morales, Jonathan Hernandez

Recreational Activity Tracker – 1

1. What typically gets you motivated or inspired to pick up a new recreational activity?
 - a. What was the exact trigger or moment that made you decide to try the last activity you started.
2. What have been some major issues or roadblocks for you when starting a new recreational activity?
 - a. In those couple of weeks (or just mention the time they said if they mentioned it) where specifically did you run into confusion, frustration, or unexpected delays?
3. What sources or tools do you rely on when you decide to get started in a new activity?
4. Walk me through how you currently keep track of your recreational activities, projects, or progress.
5. Tell me about the last time another person affected whether you continued or stopped a recreational activity.
6. Tell me about the last recreational activity you started because of a friend, group, or community.
7. Think about a hobby you have made progress in recently. What happened that made you recognize that progress?
 - a. How did you document or verify that milestone when it occurred (a photo, a metric, a finished item, comparison, sharing)?
8. Tell me about the last time competition, comparison, or another person's progress affected your participation in an activity.
 - a. Were you looking at a specific leaderboard, post, or metric when that happened?
9. Tell me about the last meaningful project, milestone, or achievement you completed in a recreational activity. What did you do with it afterward?
 - a. Did you log it, share it, or store it somewhere specific once it was completed?
10. Tell me about the last time you lost motivation or stopped participating in a recreational activity. What contributed to that?
11. Walk me through how you schedule or plan out time for your recreational activities ahead of time?

Budget Simulation Questions - 2

1. Tell me about the last significant purchase you made. How did you decide whether you could afford it?
2. Tell me about the last purchase you wanted to make but decided not to. What influenced your decision?
3. Walk me through how you currently evaluate whether a purchase fits within your budget.
 - a. What do you usually check or calculate?
4. Tell me about the last time you were uncertain whether something was worth its price. What did you do?
 - a. What ultimately helped you make your decision?
5. Tell me about the last time you changed your spending habits because you wanted to buy something.
 - a. What did you change?
 - b. How long did you have to make those changes?
6. What information did you look at before making your most recent expensive purchase?
7. Tell me about the last time an unexpected expense changed a purchase you were planning to make.
 - a. How did you adjust your plans?
8. What tools, methods, or people did you use the last time you needed help deciding whether you could afford a purchase?
 - a. Was there anything they didn't help you figure out?
9. How do you keep track of your spending?
 - a. Walk me through the last time you checked your spending.
 - b. What information do you usually look for when you check it?
10. Tell me about the last time a purchase affected your finances more than you expected after you bought it.
 - a. What and how did you adjust afterward?

Budget Simulation Project

Interview 1

Interviewer(s)	Karina Rivera		
Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	2:41 pm
Location	El Paso Community College		
Phase (1 or 2)	1	Idea or problem area	Budget Simulation Project Idea

Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	EPCC Employee
How they were reached	Reached in person at EPCC
Relevant experience with the problem area	
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

Question 1

Tell me about the last significant purchase you made. How did you decide whether you could afford it?

- “Getting a parking decal that was \$400 for the university.”
- “It was a very important purchase because it helps me be able to have parking at the university.
- “I was able to afford it because luckily, I get student financial aid that can help me support it, but I can be able to pay it off in payments as the semester goes on.”

Question 2

Tell me about the last purchase you wanted to make but decided not to. What influenced your decision?

- “To be able to get my husband a computer, but right now I cannot afford it.”
- “I had to make the decision to wait on it and get it for him later due to prioritizing other financial necessities.”

Question 3

Walk me through how you currently evaluate whether a purchase fits within your budget.

- “I do my research, I see the type of product that im looking to purchase, I see the different items that are on the market, i see the ones that are similar, if they do the same thing.”

Question 3.1

What do you usually check or calculate?

- “I also compare prices and see which one fits my budget best.”
- “It’s important for me to study the product to see if it meets what I'm looking for if it makes a difference when I use it.”

Question 4

Tell me about the last time you were uncertain whether something was worth its price. What did you do?

- “When I got my equipment for school, whether it's a laptop or an iPad. I see if it's an item that is compatible with what I'm trying to do, what I'm trying to use.”

Question 4.1

What ultimately helped you make your decision?

- “I do compare prices and of course there are some that are a little bit more affordable.”

Question 6

Tell me about the last time you changed your spending habits because you wanted to buy something.

- “I maybe didn't spend money impulsively if there was something that i really wanted.”

Question 6.1

What did you change?

- “I would research and look at the price for it and set aside money or save it over a few paychecks.”

Question 7

What information did you look at before making your most recent expensive purchase?

- “I looked at a lot of reviews and see if the product is well made, if it's compatible, if it's a really good product.”
- “Reviews on the website or google reviews.”

Question 8

How do you keep track of your spending?

- “Unfortunately, I should probably document it more on paper.”
- “The only way I keep track of my spending is constantly looking at my account.”

Question 8.1

What information do you usually look for when you check it?

- “How much I have in my savings.”

Question 9

Tell me about the last time a purchase affected your finances more than you expected after you bought it.

- “Previously the stuff that I had purchased for school such as books or access codes. Sometimes they don’t get covered fully with financial aid and I had to use my personal money to purchase these items, so they have affected my life and being able to buy other necessities that I need.”

Interview 2

Interviewer(s)	Karina Rivera		
Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	4:44 pm
Location	El Paso Community College		
Phase (1 or 2)	1	Idea or problem area	Budget Simulation Project Idea

Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	EPCC Employee
How they were reached	Reached in person at EPCC
Relevant experience with the problem area	
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

Question 1

Tell me about the last significant purchase you made. How did you decide whether you could afford it?

- “Covering for my semester, what financial aid couldn’t cover.”
- “My decision making for that is that I need it for my studies.”

Question 2

Tell me about the last purchase you wanted to make but decided not to. What influenced your decision?

- “I wanted to buy a video game.”
- “The reason why i didn’t do it was because I had to prioritize other things such as my rent and my own studies, so I have to have some self-control.”

Question 3

What information did you look at before making your most recent expensive purchase?

- “I look for other places with better offers and different selling marketplaces.”

Question 4

What tools, methods, or people did you use the last time you needed help deciding whether you could afford a purchase?

- “I keep some notes of what I'm spending throughout the month, so I look at them.”
- “When I see that I'm spending more money than the previous month, I abstain from making more purchases.”

Question 5

Walk me through how you currently evaluate whether a purchase fits within your budget.

- “I do my research, I see the type of product that im looking to purchase, I see the different items that are on the market, i see the ones that are similar, if they do the same thing.”

Question 6

Tell me about the last time a purchase affected your finances more than you expected after you bought it.

- “I bought a subscription to a streaming service, and at the time I thought it wouldn't reflect that much on my balance at the very end of the year, but it did.”

Interview 3

Interviewer(s)	Karina Rivera		
Date	Sep 10, 2026	Time	11:36 am
Location	UTEP		

Phase (1 or 2)	1	Idea or problem area	Budget Simulation Project Idea
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Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	UTEP Student
How they were reached	Reached in person at UTEP
Relevant experience with the problem area	
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

Question 1

Tell me about the last significant purchase you made. How did you decide whether you could afford it?

- “Tuition, and to be able to afford it I was setting money aside for it, for a good while.

Question 2

Tell me about the last purchase you wanted to make but decided not to. What influenced your decision?

- “I was going to buy a new purse.”
- “Then I decided I didn’t need it right now, and that I could wait.”

Question 3

Tell me about the last time you changed your spending habits because you wanted to buy something.

- “The last time I changed my spending habits, I kind of just looked at my budget and saw, like, what I was spending, like one unnecessary stuff, like going out, or like eating, like fast food, when I could just make it at home.”

Question 4

What tools, methods, or people did you use the last time you needed help deciding whether you could afford a purchase?

- “My parents, they have definitely been good advice.”
- “Then I ChatGPT my budget to give me advice.”

Question 5

How do you keep track of your spending?

- “I honestly don’t”
- “I just look at my bank statements and see like what it is and base it on that.”

Question 5.1

What information do you usually look for when you check it?

- “My balance, the amounts I spend and how much it affects it.”

Question 6

Tell me about the last time a purchase affected your finances more than you expected after you bought it.

- “I ended up going to get my car fixed for like a simple thing, and then it ended up being like three times more.”

Question 6.1

What and how did you adjust afterward?

- “Thankfully, I was able to pay it, but I wasn’t anticipating paying that much at the time. So, I kind of had to work around and like budget for the next few weeks after to make up for that.”

Interview 4

Interviewer(s)	Karina Rivera		
Date	Sep 10, 2026	Time	12:15 pm
Location	UTEP		

Phase (1 or 2)	1	Idea or problem area	Budget Simulation Project Idea
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Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	UTEP Student
How they were reached	Reached in person at UTEP
Relevant experience with the problem area	
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

Question 1

Tell me about the last significant purchase you made. How did you decide whether you could afford it?

- “My headphones, these Sony XM5.”
- “I just checked my bank account, then deducted that I had enough to make the purchase.”

Question 2

Tell me about the last purchase you wanted to make but decided not to. What influenced your decision?

- “An electronic drum set.”
- “I was thinking about getting it, but they are all like super expensive, and I didn’t think it would fit in my budget.”

Question 3

Tell me about the last time you changed your spending habits because you wanted to buy something.

- “Stopped spending so much on like going out and eating out.”

Question 4

What information did you look at before making your most recent expensive purchase?

- “If it’ll be worth it so like looking at the specs, like the headphones for example, and looking at if it was worth the money.”

Question 5

What tools, methods, or people did you use the last time you needed help deciding whether you could afford a purchase?

- “The bank count app. Checking the status.”

Question 6

Tell me about the last time a purchase affected your finances more than you expected after you bought it.

- “Going out, like with my friends, and spending more than I anticipated.”

Interview 5

Interviewer(s)	Karina Rivera		
Date	Sep 10, 2026	Time	12:27 pm
Location	UTEP		
Phase (1 or 2)	1	Idea or problem area	Budget Simulation Project Idea

Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	UTEP Student
How they were reached	Reached in person at UTEP
Relevant experience with the problem area	
Consent to take notes given?	Yes

Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed
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Question 1

Tell me about the last significant purchase you made. How did you decide whether you could afford it?

- “If there is Klarna, like after pay, then I could do that.”
- “If I break it down then I feel like I can afford it rather than pay it full.”

Question 2

Walk me through how you currently evaluate whether a purchase fits within your budget.

- “I have a set income for the month. I think about what I might have to pay for, and then factor that in.”

Question 3

Tell me about the last time you changed your spending habits because you wanted to buy something.

- “Recently, I would just put a lot of money on my saving account, so I wouldn’t touch it, and then it would like a accumulate, and then I could get what I wanted.”

Question 3.1

How long did you have to make those changes?

- “Probably like two months.”

Question 4

Tell me about the last time an unexpected expense changed a purchase you were planning to make.

- “My dog always has to go to the vet, I usually spend the money there.”

Question 5

What tools, methods, or people did you use the last time you needed help deciding whether you could afford a purchase?

- “Sometimes I’ll ask, like ChatGPT.”

Question 6

How do you keep track of your spending?

- “I honestly don’t. I just keep like a mental note.”

Question 7

Tell me about the last time a purchase affected your finances more than you expected after you bought it.

- “Probably when my dog goes to the vet.”
- “It always ends up being more than I thought it would be.”

Question 7.1

What and how did you adjust afterward?

- “I would eat at home a lot.”

Interview 6

Interviewer(s)	Juan Reyna		
Date	Sep 10, 2026	Time	3:20 pm
Location	Horizon City		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Budget Simulation Project Idea

Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	Passerby
How they were reached	Reached in person
Relevant experience with the problem area	They have experience in budgeting using excel for their weekly income.
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

Question 1:

Tell me about the last significant purchase you made. How did you decide whether you could afford it?

- Their last significant purchase was a video game console. They had to analyze if they could purchase this while also paying for their monthly expenses without limiting their spending in other areas.

Question 2:

Tell me about the last purchase you wanted to make but decided not to. What influenced your decision?

- They wanted to purchase an expensive piece of equipment for their home, however since it was expensive and they couldn't fit it into their budget, they shut down that idea.

Question 3:

Walk me through how you currently evaluate whether a purchase fits within your budget. What do you usually check or calculate?

- They have an excel sheet that they use to break down their weekly paychecks. Knowing how much they have for their monthly expenses and savings while also having some for their fun purchases.

Question 4:

Tell me about the last time you were uncertain whether something was worth its price. What did you do?

- They were looking at some headphones that were costly, but the main reason was that they realized that they do not wear headphones enough of the time to justify the purchase.

Question 5:

Tell me about the last time you changed your spending habits because you wanted to buy something.

- When they needed to make an expensive purchase, they would look at their excel sheet and sacrifice their spending in non essential areas like entertainment, then move on to other areas if needed.

Interview 7

Interviewer(s)	Juan Reyna		
Date	Sep 10, 2026	Time	3:40 pm
Location	Horizon City		

Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Budget Simulation Project Idea
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Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	Passerby
How they were reached	Reached in person
Relevant experience with the problem area	Planning to move soon and plans and make purchases for that new home.
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

Question 1:

Tell me about the last significant purchase you made. How did you decide whether you could afford it?

- Their last significant purchases were purchasing new homeware such as cookware, bathroom supplies, etc. They had it in their budget beforehand, so they purchased it after months of budgeting and planning.

Question 2:

Tell me about the last purchase you wanted to make but decided not to. What influenced your decision?

- The purchases they wanted was a new deck set for a tabletop game they play. However, they considered their monthly expenses, so they didn't make the purchase and waited.

Question 3:

Walk me through how you currently evaluate whether a purchase fits within your budget. What do you usually check or calculate?

- They do not use a tool for their budgeting, they set themselves a limit and hope they do not go overboard.

Question 4:

Tell me about the last time you were uncertain whether something was worth its price. What did you do?

- Wether to get takeout food or not, since they know that it would be more cost efficient. But doesn't realize it beforehand, so the guilt and realization come after the purchase of take out.

Question 5:

Tell me about the last time you changed your spending habits because you wanted to buy something.

- When they overspent on entertainment and didn't have much left for their monthly expenses, afterwards they changed their allocation of spending drastically and stuck with it.

Interview 8

Interviewer(s)	Ricardo Morales Perez		
Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	Around 3:00 pm
Location	UTEP BUSS		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker

Role or descriptor	UTEP Student
How they were reached	Reached in person at UTEP
Relevant experience with the problem area	
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not Mentioned

Question 1:

Tell me about the last significant purchase you made. How did you decide whether you could afford it?

- Fabletics gym clothes, if I could buy it twice I could afford it.

Question 2:

Tell me about the last purchase you wanted to make but decided not to. What influenced your decision?

- Smart watch, I wouldn't really get the cost out of it.

Question 3:

Walk me through how you currently evaluate whether a purchase fits within your budget.

- a. What do you usually check or calculate? \
- If I still have money for any emergency and bills I can spend on something that isn't a NECCESITY

Question 4:

Tell me about the last time you were uncertain whether something was worth its price. What did you do?

- a. What ultimately helped you make your decision?
- I wanted to purchase a backpack for the gym, I realized I was going off more of wants and not needs, there where better options for a lesser price.

Question 5:

Tell me about the last time you changed your spending habits because you wanted to buy something.

- a. What did you change?
- I usually go out to eat a lot, I did a couple weeks cooking at home in order to save.
- b. How long did you have to make those changes?
- A couple weeks.

Question 6:

What information did you look at before making your most recent expensive purchase?

- What bills, or payments I needed to take care of and if I made the purchase would I still be really well of financially.

Interview 9

Interviewer(s)	Ricardo Morales Perez		
Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	Around 3:30 pm
Location	UTEP BUSS		

Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker
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Role or descriptor	UTEP Student
How they were reached	Reached in person at UTEP
Relevant experience with the problem area	
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not Mentioned

Question 1:

Tell me about the last significant purchase you made. How did you decide whether you could afford it?

- I looked at my account and said yeah I can afford it

Question 2:

Tell me about the last purchase you wanted to make but decided not to. What influenced your decision?

- It was actually super cheap, but it was non-financial reasons (diet)

Question 3:

Walk me through how you currently evaluate whether a purchase fits within your budget.

- I look at my account and if the number is higher than the price I buy
 - a. What do you usually check or calculate?
- money I have minus cost of thing

Question 4:

Tell me about the last time you were uncertain whether something was worth its price. What did you do?

- a. What ultimately helped you make your decision?
 - If I am uncertain I don't purchase

Question 5:

Tell me about the last time you changed your spending habits because you wanted to buy something.

- a. What did you change?
 - I won't buy fast food if I'm saving for something
- b. How long did you have to make those changes?
 - 6 months

Question 6:

What information did you look at before making your most recent expensive purchase?

- the price of alternatives

Interview 10

Interviewer(s)	Ricardo Morales Perez		
Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	Around 3:30 pm
Location	UTEP BUSS		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker

Role or descriptor	UTEP Student
How they were reached	Reached in person at UTEP
Relevant experience with the problem area	
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not Mentioned

Question 1:

Tell me about the last significant purchase you made. How did you decide whether you could afford it?

- I knew how much I made a month and it was not over 25% of that.

Question 2:

Tell me about the last purchase you wanted to make but decided not to. What influenced your decision?

- How frequent my last big purchase was I didn't want to do 2 so close together.

Question 3:

Walk me through how you currently evaluate whether a purchase fits within your budget.

- I think about it in terms of a percentage of my monthly income.
- a. What do you usually check or calculate?
- The Price of the purchase divided by my monthly income

Question 4:

Tell me about the last time you were uncertain whether something was worth its price. What did you do?

- a. What ultimately helped you make your decision?
- If I am uncertain I don't purchase

Question 5:

Tell me about the last time you changed your spending habits because you wanted to buy something.

- a. What did you change?
- I won't buy fast food if I'm saving for something
- b. How long did you have to make those changes?
- 1 month

Question 6:

What information did you look at before making your most recent expensive purchase?

- the price of alternatives.

Interview 11

Interviewer(s)	Ricardo Morales Perez		
Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	Around 4:00 pm
Location	UTEP BUSS		

Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker
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Role or descriptor	UTEP Student
How they were reached	Reached in person at UTEP
Relevant experience with the problem area	
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not Mentioned

Question 1:

Tell me about the last significant purchase you made. How did you decide whether you could afford it?

- I bought tickets to Halloween horror nights for my family and my friend and I decided I could afford it because it was a group trip and we all took turns paying for things.

Question 2:

Tell me about the last purchase you wanted to make but decided not to. What influenced your decision?

- I was thinking of buying a keychain but I decided against it because I thought it would be too much money spent on myself.

Question 3:

Walk me through how you currently evaluate whether a purchase fits within your budget.

- I always focus on whether it's for me or someone else and if it's me then I try to be more strict.
 - a. What do you usually check or calculate?
- I look at my bank account and make sure I have enough for any bills my card might get charged for.

Question 4:

Tell me about the last time you were uncertain whether something was worth its price. What did you do?

- Concert tickets are something I'm always buying so that's usually what I contemplate but if I like the artist enough they are always a priority to me.
- a. What ultimately helped you make your decision?
- How much I'm interested in what I'm buying and whether I will regret it in the future

Question 5:

Tell me about the last time you changed your spending habits because you wanted to buy something.

- I had been spending a lot of money but then I stopped having a job so I had to be more strict on what I spent and I decided to only buy food for a couple months until I finally got a job again.
- a. What did you change?
- Now I tend to focus more on saving money for upcoming trips rather than items I want to buy due to the fact that I've been traveling a lot.
- b. How long did you have to make those changes?
- A couple of months

Question 6:

What information did you look at before making your most recent expensive purchase?

- Again my bank account and I took into account how much everyone around me was spending on me.

Interview 12

Interviewer(s)	Ricardo Morales Perez		
Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	Around 6:00 pm
Location	UTEP BUSS		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker

Role or descriptor	UTEP Student
How they were reached	Reached in person at UTEP
Relevant experience with the problem area	

Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not Mentioned

Question 1:

Tell me about the last significant purchase you made. How did you decide whether you could afford it?

- I would say my last significant purchase was tickets to the Karol G concert. I made sure I had enough money in my savings account and still enough leftover.

Question 2:

Tell me about the last purchase you wanted to make but decided not to. What influenced your decision?

- My last purchase I wanted to make but decided not to was tickets to a music festival. The reason I choose not to but them was the high cost of them.\

Question 3:

Walk me through how you currently evaluate whether a purchase fits within your budget.

- I would say I look at how much money I have in my savings account and make sure it doesn't decrease it by too much and I make sure it is not a significant portion of my paycheck.
- a. What do you usually check or calculate?
- The percentage of the purchase out of my paycheck.

Question 4:

Tell me about the last time you were uncertain whether something was worth its price. What did you do?

- The last time I was uncertain about whether something was worth the price was the music festival tickets. I evaluated how much that experience was worth to me and whether I was willing to pay that amount for that experience.
- a. What ultimately helped you make your decision?
- I was able to compare similar experiences I have had and ultimately decided the price was too high.

Question 5:

Tell me about the last time you changed your spending habits because you wanted to buy something.

- Recently, after wanting to buy more things such as concert tickets, I have decreased my spending in other areas such as eating out.
- a. What did you change?

- I decreased my spending in other areas such as eating out.
- b. How long did you have to make those changes?
- I have only been making these changes for about a month

Question 6:

What information did you look at before making your most recent expensive purchase?

- I looked at the prices for the item I bought in different areas as well as my personal bank account amounts.

Recreational Activity Tracker

Interview 1

Interviewer(s)	Isaac Padilla		
Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	12:45pm
Location	UTEP		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker

Role or descriptor	UTEP Student
How they were reached	Reached in person at UTEP
Relevant experience with the problem area	Uses Google, online content creators, and search results to explore new learning activities. Manages work, social events, family events, and recreational activities using Apple Calendar.
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

Question 1:

What typically gets you motivated or inspired to pick up a new recreational activity?

- The participant is motivated by long-term career goals.
- They want to gain knowledge, tools, and information that will help them get closer to those goals.
- The participant recently began researching companies, including how to create them, start them, and acquire talent.
- Their goal is to own “something big, something fun.”

Note: The participant chooses new activities based on whether they support future personal or career goals.

Question 2:

What have been some major issues or roadblocks for you when starting a new recreational activity?

- The participant said there is a large amount of information available online.

- They find it difficult to “siphon through the right information” and find what they need.
- The participant also said that limited time is a major challenge.
- They want to start and learn many things, but “time is just limited.”

Question 3:

What sources or tools do you rely on when you decide to get started in a new activity?

- The participant starts with Google or another search engine.
- They begin with a general search.
- They may become interested in a product or activity after seeing YouTubers or mainstream online personalities discuss it.
- The participant uses a combination of general web searches and recommendations from online content creators.
- Note: The participant begins broadly with Google, then follows leads from online personalities or product discussions.

Question 4:

Walk me through how you currently keep track of your recreational activities, projects, or progress.

- The participant uses the Apple Calendar on their phone.
- They divide their week and days based on work, social events, family events, and other responsibilities.
- They put activities and events into the calendar to keep track of them.
- The participant has difficulty sharing their schedule with friends.
- They said other apps may do a better job of sharing schedules.
- They find it difficult to give someone access to their whole schedule.
- They also find it difficult when someone else shares their schedule and they need to turn it on or off.

Branching Question:

Does using Apple Calendar create any problems for recreational activities?

- The main issue is sharing schedules with friends.
- The participant wants an easier way to share their whole schedule and access other people’s schedules.
- They find schedule-sharing controls difficult to manage.

Question 5:

Tell me about the last recreational activity you started because of a friend, group, or community.

- The participant started learning Korean about a year ago.
- The participant eventually stopped or paused learning Korean.
- They said limited time contributed to dropping the activity.

Branching Question:

What made you stop learning Korean?

- The participant said the main reason was time.

- They want to start and learn many things but have limited time available.

Question 6:

Think about a hobby you have made progress in recently. What happened that made you recognize that progress?

- The participant discussed progress related to starting a company.
- They purchased a tablet to support studying and note-taking.
- The participant views the tablet as an investment in their learning and future goal.
- They previously took notes on paper or typed on a computer.
- They wanted an option between paper notes and typing with a keyboard.
- Paper became too messy and difficult to organize.
- The participant could not previously purchase a tablet because of financial limitations.
- Being able to afford the tablet represented progress toward their goal.

Note: The participant recognizes progress through obtaining useful tools and making investments that improve their ability to learn and work toward a larger goal.

Question 7:

Tell me about the last time competition, comparison, or another person's progress affected your participation in an activity.

- The participant generally does not compare themselves to other people.
- They believe learning progress should be compared to one's own previous progress.
- They said people learn at different speeds and have different tools or resources available.
- The participant does look at other people's goals to set higher achievable goals for themselves.
- They gave an example of seeing someone aim for "the clouds" and then setting their own goal to reach "the moon."

Note: The participant avoids direct comparison but uses other people's goals as motivation to set higher personal goals.

Interview 2

Interviewer(s)	Isaac Padilla		
Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	1:10pm
Location	UTEP		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker

Role or descriptor	UTEP Student
How they were reached	Reached in person at UTEP
Relevant experience with the problem area	Uses YouTube and ChatGPT to explore recreational activities, especially building-related projects.
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

Question 1:

What typically gets you motivated or inspired to pick up a new recreational activity?

- The participant is motivated by seeing other people do activities.
- They may become interested after watching a video on YouTube.
- Seeing another person do something can remind them that they wanted to try it too.
- The participant described building things as a recreational activity.

Note: Videos and observing other people's activities can prompt the participant to begin or return to an activity.

Question 2:

What have been some major issues or roadblocks for you when starting a new recreational activity?

- The participant loses interest when an activity has many steps before they can get to "the fun stuff."
- Setup is a major roadblock.

Note: The participant is discouraged by lengthy preparation or setup requirements before the enjoyable part of an activity.

Question 3:

What sources or tools do you rely on when you decide to get started in a new activity?

- The participant uses YouTube for information.
- The participant also uses ChatGPT.

Question 4:

Walk me through how you currently keep track of your recreational activities, projects, or progress.

- The participant does not currently have a system for keeping track of recreational activities or projects.
- They said, "I actually don't, and that's a problem."
- The participant said they forget activities and projects.
- Once they start something, they get energy to continue and remember other things they should be doing.

Note: The participant identified keeping track of activities and avoiding forgetfulness as a problem.

Question 5:

Think about a hobby you have made progress in recently. What happened that made you recognize that progress?

- The participant said it can be difficult to see progress while working on an activity.
- They said, “Sometimes you don’t see it until you are done with it.”
- The participant tries to maintain a positive mindset.
- They encourage themselves by recognizing what they have accomplished.
- They described stopping and looking at what they have done as a way to recognize progress.

Note: The participant recognizes progress through reflection after completing work rather than through ongoing metrics or tracking.

Question 6:

Tell me about the last time you lost motivation or stopped participating in a recreational activity. What contributed to that?

- The participant said they often start projects and then stop.
- They stop because of time and “real life stuff.”
- When time passes after stopping an activity, they lose the motivation they originally had.

Note: Interruptions from other responsibilities make it difficult for the participant to return to a project after pausing it.

Question 7:

Walk me through how you schedule or plan out time for your recreational activities ahead of time.

- The participant tries to complete necessary tasks and priorities first.
- Recreational activities happen after their required tasks are completed.
- The participant does not make detailed schedules for recreational activities.
- They said they “just bunch it.”
- The participant has difficulty following time limits, even when they plan to work on something for only one hour.
- Once they start an activity and are having fun, they continue for long periods.
- They said they may keep going “for days and days” and continue even when they are sleepy.

Note: The participant prioritizes required tasks first but has difficulty setting and following boundaries for recreational activity time.

Interview 3

Interviewer(s)	Isaac Padilla
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Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	1:22pm
Location	UTEP		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker

Role or descriptor	UTEP Student
How they were reached	Reached in person at UTEP
Relevant experience with the problem area	Uses YouTube, Instagram, and TikTok to discover and learn new recreational activities by watching other people and attempting to replicate what they see.
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

Question 1:

What typically gets you motivated or inspired to pick up a new recreational activity?

- The participant is motivated by learning something new.
- They are interested in activities that “use the mind” and challenge them.
- They enjoy the feeling of figuring something out little by little.
- The participant described this feeling as a “dopamine rush.”
- Learning a skill makes them feel successful, even when the skill is not necessary for a specific purpose.
- They enjoy feeling that they have learned something new for themselves.

Question 2:

What sources or tools do you rely on when you decide to get started in a new activity?

- The participant uses social media to learn about new activities.
- They use YouTube, Instagram, and TikTok.
- They watch highlights or videos of other people doing an activity.
- They then try to replicate the activity at home or try it themselves.
- Note: The participant uses short-form and video-based content to observe an activity before attempting it.

Question 3:

What have been some major issues or roadblocks for you when starting a new recreational activity?

- The participant said the hardest part is that they do not like failure.
- Failing at an activity frustrates and annoys them.
- Failure can keep the participant working on an activity, but it also creates a roadblock.
- When frustrated, the participant has difficulty thinking of “outside-the-box ways” to solve a problem.
- They may become focused on doing something only one specific way.

Note: Failure can motivate the participant to keep trying, but it can also make them rigid and less able to explore alternative approaches.

Question 4:

Walk me through how you currently keep track of your recreational activities, projects, or progress.

- The participant schedules approximately 30 minutes to one hour for an activity.
- They do not participate in every activity every day.
- They aim to work on a recreational activity at least once or twice a week.
- The participant does not track statistics or formal progress metrics.
- They evaluate progress based on how they feel.
- They use memory to compare their current performance with previous attempts.
- For example, they may remember whether they completed something faster or slower than before.
- Note: The participant tracks activity time informally and evaluates progress through memory and personal feelings rather than a written log or metrics.

Question 5:

Tell me about the last recreational activity you started because of a friend, group, or community.

- The participant recently started reading again.
- They used to read many books in middle school but later stopped.
- They wanted an activity that would engage their mind without spending all day on screens, videos, TikTok, or binge-watching.
- The participant reads to relax and “cool” their brain down.
- They are currently reading a Harry Potter book.

Branching Question:

Do you keep track of what you have been reading or the books you have read?

- The participant does not formally track their reading.
- They read for around 30 minutes to one hour at a time.
- They have not finished the book they are currently reading.
- They go by chapters or reading time.
- The participant does not set a deadline to finish a book in a week or month.
- They view reading as a way to relax, take time off, and cool down.

Question 6:

Tell me about the last time you lost motivation or stopped participating in a recreational activity. What contributed to that?

- The participant stopped playing soccer after leaving the city.
- They described themselves as very competitive while playing soccer.
- Soccer began to lose its hobby aspect and became “way too competitive.”
- The participant lost track of the point of playing.
- They became frustrated and would go home angry after playing.
- After moving and playing soccer in a different environment, they began to see it as fun again.
- They now view soccer as stress relief.

Note: Excessive competitiveness reduced the participant’s enjoyment and motivation, while a different playing environment helped them reconnect with soccer as a recreational activity.

Interview 4

Interviewer(s)	Isaac Padilla		
Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	1:45pm
Location	UTEP		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker

Role or descriptor	UTEP Student
How they were reached	Reached in person at UTEP
Relevant experience with the problem area	Is motivated to try activities after seeing friends, people nearby, or social-media content participate in them.
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

Question 1:

What typically gets you motivated or inspired to pick up a new recreational activity?

- The participant is motivated by seeing other people participate in an activity.
- They may be inspired by people they see in person, on social media, or through friends’ recommendations.
- The participant gave pottery and ceramics as an example.
- They saw people doing pottery at a business near their office.
- Seeing people participate made pottery look fun.

- The participant then began seeing pottery content on social media.
- They said this made them want to try working with clay and making pottery.

Question 2:

What have been some major issues or roadblocks for you when starting a new recreational activity?

- The participant said time is a major roadblock.
- They feel “very stretched” for time.
- Finding time to attend a beginner lesson is difficult.
- The participant wants to feel comfortable starting as a beginner.
- They are concerned about looking foolish while learning an activity.
- Cost is also a concern.
- The participant considers whether a class is worth paying for when they are only “testing the waters.”

Note: Time, financial uncertainty, and discomfort with being a beginner can prevent the participant from starting a new activity.

Question 3:

Walk me through how you currently keep track of your recreational activities, projects, or progress.

- The participant used exercise and yoga as examples of recreational activities.
- They do not use a formal tracking system.
- They track activity mentally based on whether they feel active lately.
- The participant pays for a gym membership that includes yoga classes.
- They try to attend the gym or yoga classes a certain number of times each week so the membership feels worth the cost.
- The participant does not use a system to measure performance or progress.

Question 4:

Think about a hobby you have made progress in recently. What happened that made you recognize that progress?

- The participant used going to the gym and working out as an example.
- They said progress does not happen quickly.
- At first, they feel weak, sore, or bad after working out.
- After consistently continuing, they begin noticing changes.
- They may notice that they can lift more weight.
- They may notice changes in how clothes fit, such as clothes feeling tighter or looser.
- The participant said progress can surprise them because they do not track it directly.
- They described progress as a “lagging indicator.”

Note: The participant notices progress through physical changes and improved ability rather than a formal measurement system.

Question 5:

Tell me about the last time you lost motivation or stopped participating in a recreational activity. What contributed to that?

- The participant wanted to start dancing at the beginning of the year.
- They were inspired after seeing friends dance well at an event.
- They wanted to be able to dance like their friends.
- The participant started taking dance classes.
- They attended a couple of classes but felt they were not good at dancing.
- Feeling inexperienced and not good at the activity was demotivating.
- The participant said their busy schedule made it easy to stop attending because they felt tired.

Note: Feeling unsuccessful as a beginner, combined with a busy schedule and tiredness, contributed to the participant stopping dance classes.

Branching Question:

What could have helped you continue the activity?

- The participant suggested a system with gamification or accountability features.
- They suggested a tool that could access their calendar and recognize that they were new to an activity.
- The participant wanted a reminder about 30 minutes before a scheduled activity.
- The tool could ask whether they were attending.
- If they said no or did not respond, it could ask why.
- The participant compared this idea to an “accountability coach.”

Note: The participant expressed interest in a calendar-connected accountability tool that could prompt reflection when they miss a planned activity.

Interview 5

Interviewer(s)	Isaac Padilla		
Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	2:05pm
Location	UTEP		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker

Role or descriptor	UTEP Student
How they were reached	Reached in person at UTEP

Relevant experience with the problem area	Starts recreational activities based on existing interests, such as music, anime, and cartoons. Uses detailed YouTube tutorials to learn how to begin new activities
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

Question 1:

What typically gets you motivated or inspired to pick up a new recreational activity?

- The participant is motivated by existing interests.
- They play guitar because they are very interested in music.
- They said a possible interest in painting or drawing could come from liking anime or cartoons.
- The participant described starting a new activity as “getting deeper” into an existing interest.

Note: Existing interests in media, art, music, or entertainment motivate the participant to explore related recreational activities.

Question 2:

What have been some major issues or roadblocks for you when starting a new recreational activity?

- The participant said materials are an initial barrier to starting certain activities.
- They said some activities can be started “right up the bat,” while others require collecting materials first.
- For painting, the participant would need supplies such as paint and a canvas.
- Budget is also a concern.
- The participant said that starting painting would require spending money on the canvas, paint, and other materials.

Note: The cost and availability of required materials can delay the participant from beginning a new activity.

Question 3:

What sources or tools do you rely on when you decide to get started in a new activity?

- The participant said they use YouTube “100%” or “almost like 99%” of the time.
- They use YouTube to find tutorials and videos about how to get started.
- Short-form videos can be helpful, but one-minute videos are often not detailed enough.
- The participant often watches longer YouTube videos, sometimes around 40 minutes, to follow instructions and details.

Note: The participant prefers detailed, long-form video tutorials when learning a new activity.

Question 4:

Walk me through how you currently keep track of your recreational activities, projects, or progress.

- The participant does not formally keep records of most recreational activities.
- If they create something, such as a painting, the finished item becomes the record of the activity.
- If they play video games, the game itself records their progress.
- The participant does not use project-management tools or another organized system to track recreational activities.
- They may take a picture of something they create.
- Pictures are stored in their phone gallery and may be difficult to find later.

Note: The participant's progress is captured within the activity itself or in unorganized phone photos rather than in a central tracking system.

Question 5:

Think about a hobby you have made progress in recently. What happened that made you recognize that progress?

- The participant used playing guitar as an example.
- They began playing guitar when they were around eight years old.
- The participant keeps a saved playlist on YouTube or Spotify containing songs they can play.
- When they learn a new song, they add it to the playlist.
- They use the playlist to play through songs they know.

Note: The participant recognizes guitar progress by tracking the number of songs they have learned and can play.

Question 6:

Tell me about the last time you lost motivation or stopped participating in a recreational activity. What contributed to that?

- The participant stopped participating in boxing.
- They said it was not mainly a loss of motivation.
- Time was one reason they stopped.
- Training began at 6:00 PM and ended at 8:00 PM.
- The schedule was more difficult during winter because it was cold and already dark outside.
- Cost was also a factor.
- The gym subscription was expensive.
- The participant also needed to purchase additional equipment, including hand wraps and gloves.

Note: Scheduling, seasonal conditions, gym membership costs, and required equipment expenses contributed to the participant stopping boxing.

Interview 6

Interviewer(s)	Juan Reyna
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Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	8:50am
Location	Horizon City		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker

Role or descriptor	Passerby
How they were reached	In Person
Relevant experience with the problem area	Tracks their progress and participated in many activities before.
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

Question 1:

What typically gets you motivated or inspired to pick up a new recreational activity?

- Motivated by activities that could build career relevant skills.

Question 2:

What have been some major issues or roadblocks for you when starting a new recreational activity?

- Fear of not being immediately good at something is the main roadblock.

Question 3:

What sources or tools do you rely on when you decide to get started in a new activity?

- Uses music to stay focused when starting something new.

Question 4:

Walk me through how you currently keep track of your recreational activities, projects, or progress.

- Tracks through their past work and current, compare past work to gauge progress.

Question 5:

Tell me about the last time another person affected whether you continued or stopped a recreational activity.

- Friends' encouragement has consistently kept them motivated to continue.

Question 6:

Tell me about the last recreational activity you started because of a friend, group, or community.

- Joined a weight-loss journey alongside a sibling.

Interview 7

Interviewer(s)	Juan Reyna		
Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	9:20am
Location	Horizon City		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker

Role or descriptor	Passerby
How they were reached	In Person
Relevant experience with the problem area	Was discouraged from activities by others, but will enjoy other communities for activities easily if all goes well
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

Question 1:

What typically gets you motivated or inspired to pick up a new recreational activity?

- Drawn to general interest and first impressions, like joining something new with a large community.

Question 2:

What have been some major issues or roadblocks for you when starting a new recreational activity?

- Lack of knowledge is the main barrier, hard to fit in around veteran participants.

Question 3:

What sources or tools do you rely on when you decide to get started in a new activity?

- Uses the internet and asks people already active in the activity.

Question 4:

Walk me through how you currently keep track of your recreational activities, projects, or progress.

- No formal system has a whiteboard but mostly keeps track mentally.

Question 5:

Tell me about the last time another person affected whether you continued or stopped a recreational activity.

- Negative experiences, bullying or toxic behavior, have driven them away from an activity.

Question 6:

Tell me about the last recreational activity you started because of a friend, group, or community.

- Was invited to a tabletop session from a friend, eventually becoming hooked on it.

Question 7:

Think about a hobby you have made progress in recently. What happened that made you recognize that progress?

- Recognizes progress through peer praise and new friendships formed.

Question 8:

Tell me about the last time competition, comparison, or another person's progress affected your participation in an activity.

- Through competitive tabletop sessions with other players, on a regular basis, it helped them improve their skills.

Question 9:

Tell me about the last meaningful project, milestone, or achievement you completed in a recreational activity. What did you do with it afterward?

- In a online tabletop game they participate in, they have earned a status that allows them to continue playing in higher difficulties, in addition, they have unlocked new content for them to experience with others.

Interview 8

Interviewer(s)	Juan Reyna		
Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	9:55am
Location	Horizon City		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker

Role or descriptor	Passerby
How they were reached	In Person
Relevant experience with the problem area	Tracks their progress and performs activities on a weekly basis
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

Question 1:

What typically gets you motivated or inspired to pick up a new recreational activity?

- Inspired by a friend doing the same activity, or by social media.

Question 2:

What have been some major issues or roadblocks for you when starting a new recreational activity?

- Time and money cited as main roadblocks, depending on the activity.

Question 3:

What sources or tools do you rely on when you decide to get started in a new activity?

- Uses internet sources such as YouTube, social media, friends, and sometimes AI like Claude or Chat.

Question 4:

Walk me through how you currently keep track of your recreational activities, projects, or progress.

- They write down their achievements and goals in a notebook, in addition, they check up on it again for changes in their progression or goals.

Question 5:

Tell me about the last time another person affected whether you continued or stopped a recreational activity.

- Someone they work out with helps maintain their consistency to keep going back to the gym.

Question 6:

Tell me about the last recreational activity you started because of a friend, group, or community.

- Their co-workers kept bugging about joining them in golf. Eventually the interviewee gave in and joined them, regularly playing the sport with them.

Question 7:

Think about a hobby you have made progress in recently. What happened that made you recognize that progress?

- Recently, after months of going the the gym, they succeeded in clearing a bench pressing goal of 225 pounds. They felt joy and a giant boost in motivation, also how it showed their progression throughout the months.

Question 8:

Tell me about the last time you lost motivation or stopped participating in a recreational activity. What contributed to that?

- Lack of time and motivation has led to stopping for weeks or months at a time.

Interview 9

Interviewer(s)	Juan Reyna		
Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	8:25am
Location	Horizon City		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker

Role or descriptor	Passerby
How they were reached	In Person
Relevant experience with the problem area	Performed weekly activity sessions with others and researched activities before going into them
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

Question 1:

What typically gets you motivated or inspired to pick up a new recreational activity?

- Motivated by viewing others doing their activities, not so much as discovering it themselves.

Question 2:

What have been some major issues or roadblocks for you when starting a new recreational activity?

- Main roadblock is their finances, not having enough to support a new hobby will ruin their experience with the new hobby.

Question 3:

What sources or tools do you rely on when you decide to get started in a new activity?

- Relies on guides found on the internet or videos online. Also, communities if they have more questions about it.

Question 4:

Tell me about the last time another person affected whether you continued or stopped a recreational activity.

- Activity ended when the host and another member relocated out of town and cannot perform their weekly activities anymore, since the host was the one who planned it.

Question 5:

Tell me about the last time you lost motivation or stopped participating in a recreational activity. What contributed to that?

- They could not continue participating their activities because of time, they feel like they have no time to do them and loses motivation.

Interview 1

Interviewer(s)	Jonathan Hernandez		
Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	6:37pm
Location	Virtually		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker

Role or descriptor	UTEP Student
How they were reached	Reached in person at UTEP

Relevant experience with the problem area	
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

What typically gets you motivated or inspired to pick up a new recreational activity?

- Generally what gets me motivated, is probably seeing something on the internet that I want to try out and determine whether I like it or not. If it's something that requires money i normally figured it out in a cheap way first.

What have been some major issues or roadblocks for you when starting a new recreational activity?

- I think a lot of these activities have a major learning curve or pre-requisite skills I need to have to get into them. So, there are a lot of skills that I don't have so I need to learn those skills first and then I can finally get into what I want to do.

What sources or tools do you rely on when you decide to get started in a new activity?

- Generally, I used YouTube, honestly that is my greatest tool.

Walk me through how you currently keep track of your recreational activities, projects, or progress.

- Usually I just use a notebook, for example during the summer break I have book to keep track of my weekly schedule and slowly adjust it as I get used to it because of college and so on.

Tell me about the last time another person affected whether you continued or stopped a recreational activity.

- I can't think of a time somebody stops me, but I can think of many times where necessary things stopped me like school, my responsibilities to a point where some of them I have given up on.

Tell me about the last recreational activity you started because of a friend, group, or community.

- Yhea for sure, since most of my recreation stuff is because I do see it from a friend or a group of people or online.

Tell me about the last meaningful project, milestone, or achievement you completed in a recreational activity. What did you do with it afterward?

- I completely this cosplay once, but I was pretty proud of myself for it and it did take about 6 months to complete and quite a bit of money.

Interview 2

Interviewer(s)	Jonathan Hernandez		
Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	8:47pm
Location	Virtually		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker
Role or descriptor	UTEP Student		
How they were reached	Virtually		
Relevant experience with the problem area			
Consent to take notes given?	Yes		
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed		

What typically gets you motivated or inspired to pick up a new recreational activity?

- For me the things that motivates me the most for picking up recreational activities would be how fun and how much I can learn for me.

What have been some major issues or roadblocks for you when starting a new recreational activity?

- Major roadblock would be the initial learning curve, like getting familiar with a new type of activity.

What sources or tools do you rely on when you decide to get started in a new activity?

- I definitely rely on doing research so a research engine in which I can get all the information I need.

Walk me through how you currently keep track of your recreational activities, projects, or progress.

- I like to keep my progress in notebooks and just have dates based on the type of note I take on activities.

Tell me about the last time another person affected whether you continued or stopped a recreational activity.

- The last time a person affected me was when I got invited into a hang out with a different person instead of doing the activity.

Tell me about the last recreational activity you started because of a friend, group, or community.

- Got into looking up of information about computers their component because of a friend.

Think about a hobby you have made progress in recently. What happened that made you recognize that progress?

- I started noticing and recognizing certain terms about a project. So specific terms that relate to it, I would understand them and realize I have made progress by remembering and knowing these terms.

Tell me about the last time competition, comparison, or another person's progress affected your participation in an activity.

- No

Tell me about the last meaningful project, milestone, or achievement you completed in a recreational activity. What did you do with it afterward?

- I started to learn on a little project how to search for open ports in specific addresses which led me to learning more about the tool and how to scan networks and find vulnerabilities about them

Interview 3

Interviewer(s)	Jonathan Hernandez
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Date	Sep 9, 2026	Time	9:23pm
Location	Virtually		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker

Role or descriptor	College Student
How they were reached	Reached Virtually
Relevant experience with the problem area	
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

What typically gets you motivated or inspired to pick up a new recreational activity?

- Usually when I see someone who is really good at something it would inspire me or being exposed to any new fresh ideas.

What have been some major issues or roadblocks for you when starting a new recreational activity?

- Learning curves, so when you reach that spot where things start to get harder and more complicated to get used to.

What sources or tools do you rely on when you decide to get started in a new activity?

- I used to google and AI to accelerate my learning.

Walk me through how you currently keep track of your recreational activities, projects, or progress.

- So, let's say I practice a song, I practice the same part over and over until I am sure I am getting it good and move into the next part until I memorize them. Then repeat and

practice into getting everything perfected. A lot of repetition but making sure it is good repetition.

Tell me about the last time another person affected whether you continued or stopped a recreational activity.

- Whenever someone doubts, I have a really strong urge to prove them wrong.

Tell me about the last recreational activity you started because of a friend, group, or community.

- I went hiking with some friends because it's good for my health even thou I personally don't like hiking.

Think about a hobby you have made progress in recently. What happened that made you recognize that progress?

- I used the fact that I wasn't able to make the sound crisp and good. So, once I get to that level it becomes crystal clear like night and day the progress I have made.

Tell me about the last time competition, comparison, or another person's progress affected your participation in an activity.

- I think every day, since now that we have social media, we are exposed to a lot of things and makes me think that I want to be like them and causing me to practice every day.

Tell me about the last meaningful project, milestone, or achievement you completed in a recreational activity. What did you do with it afterward?

- I learned a new song and sang it with friends.

Interview 4

Interviewer(s)	Jonathan Hernandez		
Date	Sep 10, 2026	Time	1:32pm
Location	UTEP		
Phase (1 or 2)	2	Idea or problem area	Recreational Activity Tracker

Role or descriptor	UTEP Student
How they were reached	Reached in person at UTEP
Relevant experience with the problem area	
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Not discussed

What typically gets you motivated or inspired to pick up a new recreational activity?

- When I have extra time or I watch a reel about sports or hiking the next day I usually go and hike.

a. What was the exact trigger or moment that made you decide to try the last activity you started.

- Like I said, I watch some YouTube video or Instagram reel about someone doing something like going to the gym and then I try it out to see if I like. In the same way this applies to racket ball and other related sports.

What have been some major issues or roadblocks for you when starting a new recreational activity?

- I guess it usually happens when you are not used to the activity. Like on the gym getting into the routine of using the supplements and other things.

a. In those couple of weeks (or just mention the time they said if they mentioned it) where specifically did you run into confusion, frustration, or unexpected delays?

- Not knowing how to work out or set up a routine when you go the gym. For example, I play racket ball and you don't know how to do it, so you with someone who knows how to play and they teach how to play. But just in general not knowing how to do it at first.

What sources or tools do you rely on when you decide to get started in a new activity?

- Honestly usually ChatGPT I just ask it stuff.

Walk me through how you currently keep track of your recreational activities, projects, or progress.

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Tell me about the last time another person affected whether you continued or stopped a recreational activity.

- Usually when you see better results on people who have been doing it for less time than you, you realize how it's not working for you so it can affect me or others.